

Project: Syria Intervention Dashboard (PEOPLE IN NEED)

Background

People In Need, an international NGO that offers humanitarian, development, and human rights support in over 40 countries worldwide, aimed to monitor and evaluate the effectiveness of its interventions for conflict-affected populations in Syria. The organization provides food aid, repairs infrastructure and water supply network, offers shelter to vulnerable individuals, distributes hygiene kits, and assists displaced families in enduring harsh winters. The objective of this project was to equip regional program managers with a real-time, interactive dashboard to track:

- the total number of beneficiaries per location (area).
- the age breakdown of beneficiaries.
- the amount of aid provided to beneficiaries.
- the average dependency ratio in different locations.
- the average income of groups coming from different locations on different dates.
- the age profile in different vulnerability criteria categories.

Approach

1. Data Collection & Sources

- Monthly reports from field officers collected via Kobo Toolbox. Kobo Toolbox data connected to Power BI via Kobo API.
- Population needs/targets from inter-agency assessments.
- Data cleaned and pre-processed in Power Query.

2. Data Modeling

- Developed a star schema model: Fact table for Household size and dimension tables for Household_Criteria, Support_Status, Socio_Economic_Criteria, Aid_Donation etc.

- Created calculated measures using DAX (e.g., Total_Food_Kits_Delivered, Total_Hygiene_Kits_Delivered, %_of_Aid_Amount, %_of_Beneficiaries, %_of_Male, %_of_Female etc.).

3. Dashboard Features

- **Cards:** Total beneficiaries, Total Food Kits, Total Hygiene Kits, Total Aid Amount.
- **Visuals:**
 - Bar charts showing Beneficiaries by Area, Beneficiaries by Age group, and Average Income of Groups by Area and Date.
 - Pie chart for gender information, and aid amount to residents & IDPs.
 - Funnel showing vulnerability categories
 - Tables: Beneficiaries by Area, Age breakdown of Beneficiaries, Aid Amount to Residents & IDPs, Average Dependency Ratio, Vulnerability Categories by Area.
- **Interactivity:**
 - **Slicer:** Filter by Area, Filter by Year/Month.

4. Deployment

- Published to Power BI Service.
- Scheduled data refresh weekly.
- Shared with PIN management and PIN Syria local team via workspace access and embedded in internal SharePoint site.

Impact

- Enabled data-driven targeting, redirecting supplies to under-reached communities.
- Improved reporting efficiency for cluster coordination and donor updates.
- Facilitated gap analysis across humanitarian sectors.